SEO ARCADE · SEO SOP

Find Global Page Speed Fixes by Sampling Five Pages

Objective

A short, ordered list of page speed fixes with the global ones on top. A problem that shows up on several sampled pages usually lives in a template, a site-wide script or a shared component, so one fix speeds up every page that shares it. On enterprise accounts, that first visible win buys the next ticket.

> *"Don't sample only a singular page because not every page is going to tell the same story." - Erika Braeger, Ten Speed*

Key Steps

1. **Pick four or five pages, not one.** Spread them across page types: homepage, core product or service page, blog post, category or resource page, a landing page with a form. (mix inferred)
2. **Test every page the same way, on mobile and desktop** (e.g. PageSpeed Insights). Log load time and total page weight in one sheet.
3. **Flag any page at or near 2 MB.** Erika's rule of thumb: "two megabytes or less. Ideally a lot less." It is the line where you zoom in, not a target.
4. **Name what adds the weight:** video, image, motion graphic, form fill, reCAPTCHA. Also check incorrectly sized images, third-party JavaScript firing before user-facing content, video not set to an iframe or autoplaying, and a lazy-loaded hero.
5. **Run each heavy element through the decision tree:** replace it, modify it, or remove it. One decision per element.
6. **Sort fixes into global and page-specific.** A culprit on three of five pages is global and goes to the top.
7. **Ship the biggest global fix first, then take the win** to every team it touches to earn buy-in for the next one.
8. **Re-test the same pages after each release** and work down the list, ordered by what moves the needle most.

Cautionary Notes

- Never lazy-load the hero image. Lazy-load below the fold only.
- 2 MB is Erika's rule of thumb for total page weight, not a Google rule. Google documents that Googlebot crawls the first 2 MB of each file (uncompressed) and the first 64 MB of a PDF.
- Redirect every retired URL as it ships. An unredirected, well-linked URL turns into 4xxs across the site.
- A sample from one template is not a sample.

Tips for Efficiency

- Offer image fixes as good, better, best. The right one depends on the server and the developers.
- Lost a position in a SERP or an LLM? Speed-test the 2-3 competitors that pulled ahead and show the gap. In B2B SaaS a bounce costs recurring revenue.
- Upload chunks of a Screaming Frog crawl into Claude to surface and prioritise issues, after you have made your own calls.

Source: Erika Braeger, Director of Strategy, Ten Speed, on the Unscripted SEO Podcast with Jeremy Rivera (October 2026). SOP: seoarcade.com/seo-sop-find-global-page-speed-fixes · episode at unscriptedseo.com. Details marked (inferred) are execution detail added by SEO Arcade. Google limit: developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/googlebot.